Unit 4

ANTHROPOMETRIC MEASUREMENT

4.1 INTRODUCTION:

Anthropometric measurement includes height, weight, head circumference, chest circumference and mid-arm circumference.

Quantitative expression of body mass, which indicates state of growth and health, is measured in kilograms or pounds using adult or infant weighing scale.

4.2 CHECKING WEIGHT OF AN INFANT



Infant-weighing scale [Infantometer]

Purposes:

- To check whether an infant has adequate weight for age
- To calculate food requirements
- To calculate intravenous fluids and medications
- To monitor whether an infant gaining or loosing weight depending on disease condition

Required articles

- Infant weighing scale- infantometer
- Draw sheet
- Duster
- Paper and pencil for calculation

Procedure:

1. Clean the weighing scale with wet duster
2. Place draw sheet on the scale
3. Balance the scale to read zero
4. Place the weighing scale close to the wall to prevent the child from falling
5. Instruct mother to stand beside the scale
6. Undress the child before weighing
7. Mummify the infant with the same draw sheet and place the infant on the scale
8. Place the left hand over the infant without touching
9. Note the weight
10. Lift the infant from the scale and help the mother to dress the infant
11. Check and compare previous weight
12. Difference of more than 100 gms, needs to be clarified by rechecking the infants weight immediately
13. If the difference is still the same, it should be informed to the doctor concerned.
14. If the weight is in pounds and it must be converted to kilograms using conversion table.
15. Document the weight.

1 Kg = 2.2 lbs

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